Gambling as a Deviant Behavior

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

1 **Case introduction**
Overview of Sarah's gambling addiction and its impact on her life.

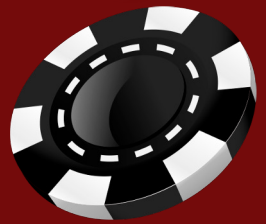
2 **Gambling & Deviance**
Definition of gambling and when it becomes a deviant behavior.

3 **Prevalence and Risk Factors**
Key statistics and factors that increase the risk of gambling addiction.

4 **Theoretical Explanations**
Social Learning Theory and Control Theory explaining gambling behavior.

5 **Supporting Research Studies**
Studies showing the role of social influence and low self-control.

6 **Prevention and Conclusion**
Strategies to reduce gambling and summary of key findings.



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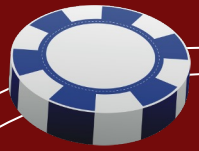
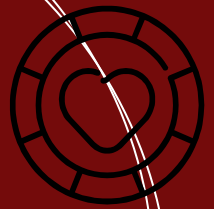
Case introduction



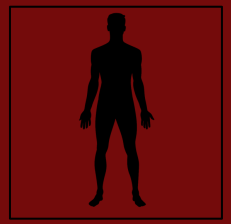


-Sarah a 34-year-old marketing executive
-Uses gambling to cope with stress
-Developed addiction → loss of control
-Financial, emotional, and social consequences

Effects of Gambling

Emotional

Mercury is the closest planet to the Sun and the smallest one



Physical

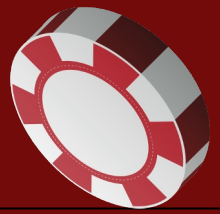
Venus has a beautiful name and is the second planet from the Sun

Social & Professional

Despite being red, Mars is a cold place. It's full of iron oxide dust

What is Gambling?

- Betting money on uncertain outcomes
- Becomes problematic when: -Repetitive
  -Uncontrollable
  -Causes harm



Gambling as Deviance

- Deviance = violation of social norms
- Gambling becomes deviant when:
  - -Responsibilities are neglected
  - -Harm continues despite consequences

Prevalence

- 35–87% university students gamble
- 60–80% teenagers gamble yearly
- Only ~3–8% develop addiction

Risk Factors

- Early exposure → higher addiction risk
- Online gambling accessibility
- Increased internet use (COVID)

The Big Question

Why do people continue gambling despite losses?

Theory 1 – Social Learning Theory

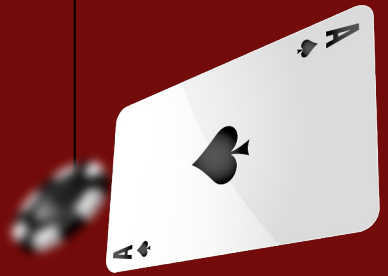
- Behavior learned from environment
- Influence of family & peers
- Gambling associated with: -Fun
  -Socializing
- Reinforced by occasional wins

Theory 2 – Control Theory

- Weak social bonds → deviance
- Low self-control → impulsive behavior
- Gambling = instant reward → hard to resist

Study 1 (Stewart & Zack, 2008)

- Gambling motives:
- Money (22.1%)
- Enjoyment (18.4%)
- Social reasons (13.3%)
- Supports Social Learning Theory



Study 2 (Bergen et al., 2012)

- More gambling = lower self-control
- Problem gamblers show:
- Poor emotional regulation
- Weak impulse control

Psychological Factors

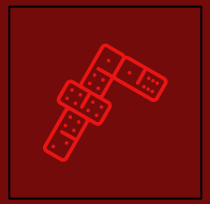
Impulsivity

Poor emotional regulation

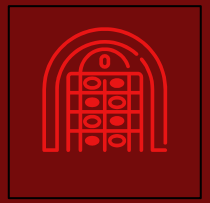
Low self-control

Social Factors

Peer influence



Cultural acceptance



Online accessibility

Prevention Strategies

-Reduce exposure to gambling

-Strengthen self-control

-Awareness programs

-Improve social bonds

Conclusion

- Gambling = cycle (stress → gambling → more problems)
- Driven by:
- Social learning
- Low self-control
- Need psychological + social interventions